in precipitating the 1962 Sino–Indian border war. But it ultimately centred on the unresolved boundary.

The India–China border consists of three sectors: the western sector in Ladakh, the middle sector abutting the Indian states of Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand (previously part of Uttar Pradesh) and the eastern sector in Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh (formerly known as the North East Frontier Agency or NEFA). The boundaries of the western and middle sectors between British India and Tibet were undefined prior to Independence. Differences over the middle sector are relatively minor and include areas around the Shipki-La Pass in Himachal Pradesh, as well as Nilang-Jadhang, Lapthal-Sangchamalla, and grazing grounds known as Barahoti north of the Nanda Devi range in Uttarakhand. [75]

Differences in the western sector are more significant. British-era maps variously showed the sparsely populated Aksai Chin as part of India and as part of Tibet. An 1865 British survey and an 1897 modification both placed Aksai Chin within India, and the rulers of Hunza and Kashmir did at times have jurisdiction over this area. The imperial Chinese government did not formally confirm any alignments in the western sector, although an 1893 Chinese proposal placed Aksai Chin as a part of China. [76] Later, in 1956 and in 1960, China advanced two different claim lines that both encompassed Aksai Chin. The 1960 line ran slightly west of the 1956 one, and also encompassed parts of the Chip Chap River and Galwan River valleys and some areas around Pangong Tso (lake). Some areas around the Kongka-la pass and parts of the Chang Chenmo River valley, as well as areas in the vicinity of Demchok and Chumur in the south-east corner of Ladakh, are also still disputed by China. [77]

The eastern sector was traditionally more defined, but even then poorly so. In 1890, Britain and China ratified the Tibet–Sikkim Convention, which defined the alignment of the boundary from the watershed of the Teesta river to the border with Nepal. [78] The boundary was redefined between Britain and Tibet in 1904 and confirmed in an agreement at the 1906 Anglo-Chinese Convention. [79] Following differences, particularly those that resulted in violent clashes in 1967, India and the People’s Republic of